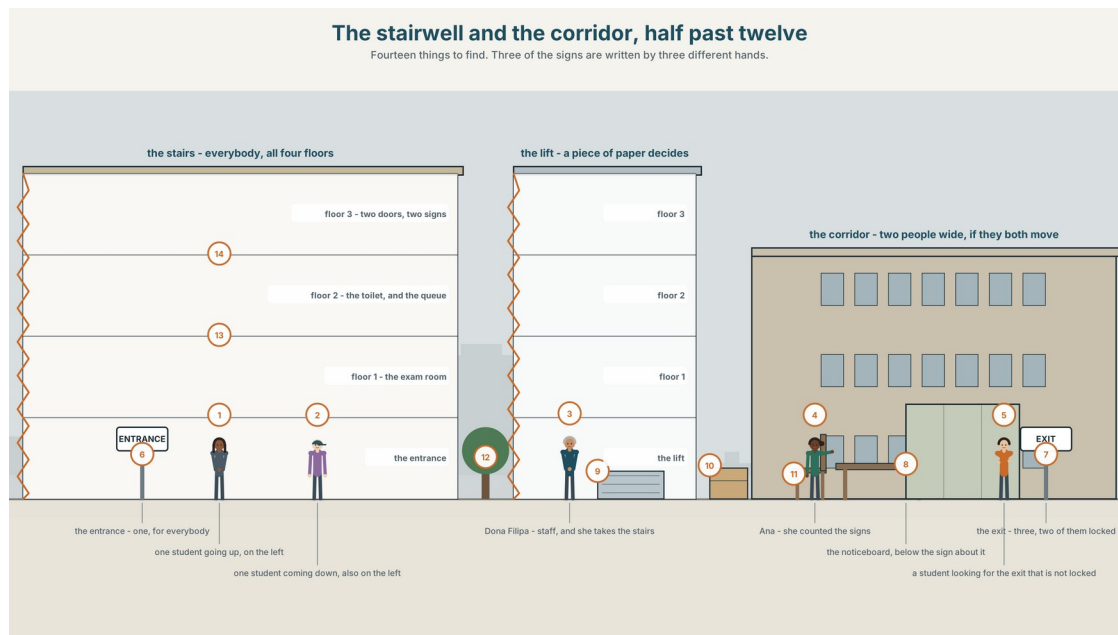


Table of Contents

A1.1 • Unit 4 • Eleven Signs, One Building

English Animated • *Starting Out* • Escola Monte, Lisbon Student's Book pages 72–93 • 22 pp • ~9 hours

Part 0 • The Big Picture ♦ A • THE WORLD



{width=6.

6in}

The stairwell and the corridor, half past twelve — Fourteen things to find. Three of the signs are written by three different hands.

Who decides the rules here?

By the end of this unit you can ask for permission, give it, and refuse it politely.

♦ A • THE WORLD

A building with eleven signs on it and nobody's name under any of them

♦ B • THE SYSTEM

can and *can't* for ability, permission and prohibition • 22 words for rules and signs • the words that make a request polite • /æ/ and /ʌ/, and the weak *can*

♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

You ask for three things you are not sure you are allowed to have

0A • Find it — fourteen things

Find these in the picture. Write the number.

☐ a sign ☐ a lift ☐ the stairs ☐ a corridor ☐ a toilet ☐ an entrance ☐ an exit ☐ a door ☐ a step ☐ a trolley ☐ a notice ☐ a clock ☐ a window ☐ a bag

Three of these words are not in the picture. Which three?

a rule · a password · a camera

0B • Guess it

Look at the signs. **Which one is the newest?** How do you know? Say one thing. You can use these words:

sign · door · open · closed · quiet

0C • Say it

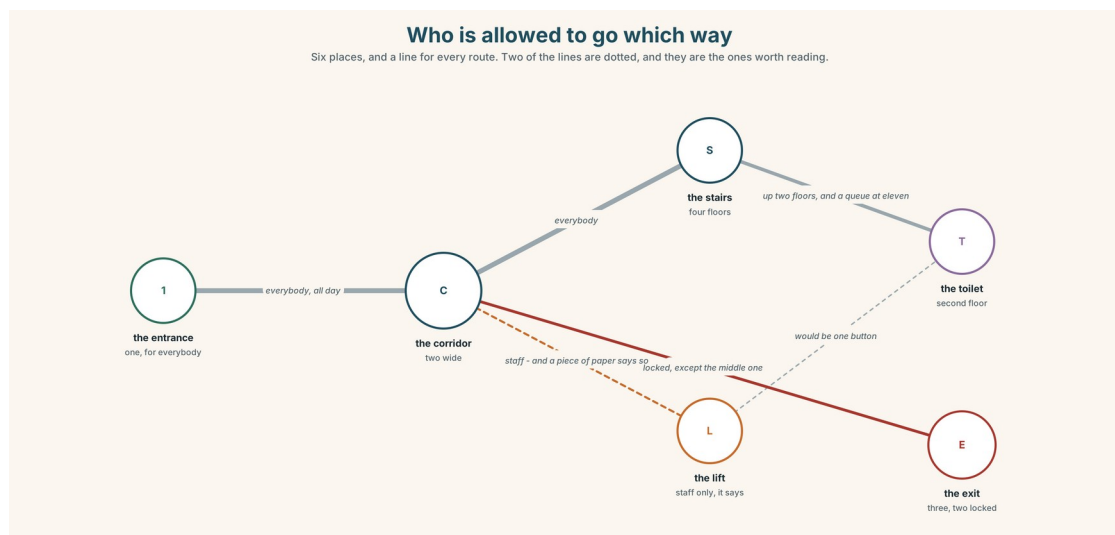
Record. Thirty seconds. Do not prepare.

What is one rule in this building, and who made it?

You will listen to this again on the last page.

Part 1 • Vocabulary Lab 1 ◆ B • THE SYSTEM

1A • Meet — the building, in signs



6in}

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Who is allowed to go which way — Six places, and a line for every route. Two of the lines are dotted, and they are the ones worth reading.

entrance

exit

One. Everybody comes through it.

Three. Two of them are locked.

stairs	Four floors. Everybody.
lift	Four floors. Staff only, says a piece of paper.
corridor	Narrow. Two people fit, if they both move.
toilet	Second floor. There is a queue at eleven.

1B • Meet — the words

rule • sign • open • closed • quiet • allowed • forbidden • entrance • exit • lift • stairs • toilet • smoking • corridor

Write each word under the right picture.

The building, in section
Eleven places. Eleven words. Put each word on the right floor.

{width=6.

6in}

The building, in section — Eleven places. Eleven words. Put each word on the right floor.

1C • Sort — a thing, or a rule about a thing?

Put each word in the right box. **Two of them can go in both. Which, and why?**

lift • quiet • sign • allowed • exit • forbidden • stairs • open • toilet • closed

A PLACE OR A THING

A RULE

BOTH

1D • What signs actually say

No smoking	Two words. It is on nine doors in this building.
Please be quiet	<i>Please</i> does not make it a request. It is still a rule.
Keep right	In the corridor. Nobody does it.

Out of order

Push / Pull

Mind the step

On the lift, twice this year.

The commonest wrong guess in any building anywhere.

There is one step. It is where the old building meets the new one.

Now say them. Five of these six are orders with no person in them. **Which one is a warning and not an order?**

1E • Stretch — the phrases you will need today

put away · take off · Out of order · Mind the step · Keep right

Match each phrase to the moment you need it.

1. You come in from the rain with a wet coat. → _____
2. The lesson is finished and your books are everywhere. → _____
3. Somebody is walking straight at you in a narrow corridor. → _____
4. You press the button and nothing happens. → _____
5. There is a small change in the floor and nobody expects it. → _____

1F • The hard one

f No problem.

Practise it three times. **Two words, and in most of the world it means yes.**

1G • Own it

Write one sign that exists in your home and one that does not exist but should. Do not write your name. The class guesses whose home it is.

Part 2 • Listening ♦ A • THE WORLD

Beside the lift, half past twelve
She is staff. The paper on the door does not know that about her.

I can't carry it up four floors.
The paper says staff only.

Four floors, twice a day, since March.

I can't carry it up four floors.
The paper says staff only.

You can use it. You are staff.
I don't know who wrote that.

Who put it there? It was before me.

Dona Filipa
staff, for nineteen years

Ana
she counted the signs

6in}

{width=6.

Beside the lift, half past twelve — She is staff. The paper on the door does not know that about her.

2A • Beside the lift Track 4.1

Before you listen. The lift says *Staff only*. Dona Filipa is staff. **Guess: is this going to be a short conversation?**

Listen once. One question. Can Dona Filipa use the lift?

Listen again. Complete the table.

	Can	Can't	Doesn't know
use the lift			
use the back exit			
leave the trolley in the corridor			

Listen again. True or false?

1. Ana wrote the notice on the lift. ☐ T ☐ F
2. Dona Filipa carries the trolley up the stairs. ☐ T ☐ F
3. Students can use the lift with a teacher. ☐ T ☐ F
4. Nobody knows who made the rule. ☐ T ☐ F

Noticing. Four sentences from the recording.

1. *You can use it.*
2. *Students can't use it.*
3. *Can I leave this here?*
4. *I can't carry it up four floors.*

Two of these are about a rule and two are about a body. Which are which?

2B • Decoding clinic Track 4.2

Twenty seconds of Ana at speed. Three jobs.

1. Count how many times she says *can*.
2. In two of them the word is very short and quiet. In two it is loud. Which two are loud?
3. She says *can't* once. What is the difference you hear — the vowel, or the *t*?

Transcripts, page 150.

Part 3 • Grammar Lab 1 B • THE SYSTEM

One word, three jobs

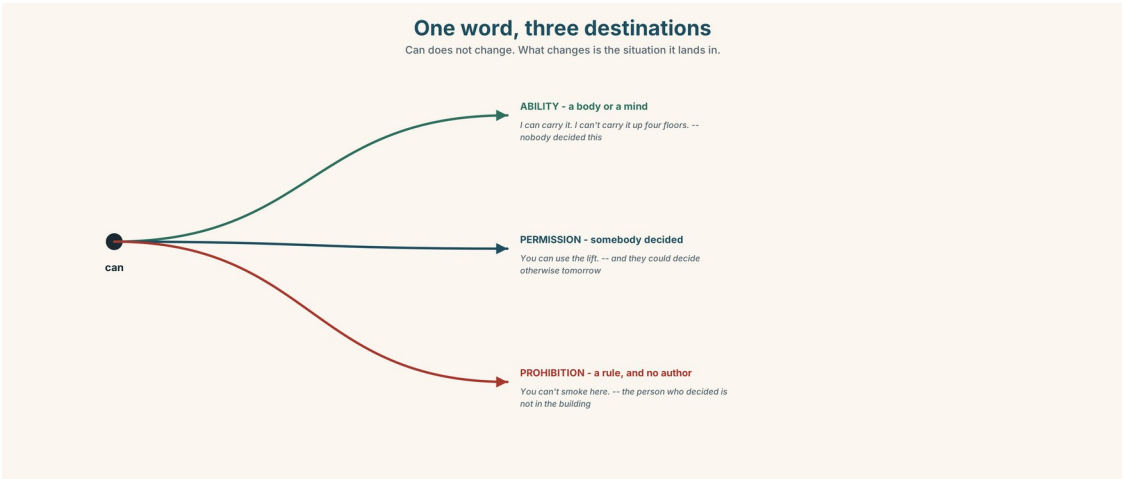
3A • Notice

Look at the four sentences in Part 2 again.

1. Does *can* change after *I*, *you*, *she* or *they*?
2. What is the form of the verb straight after *can*?

- 3. How do you make a question with *can*?
- 4. One sentence is about something a body cannot do. Which?

3B • See



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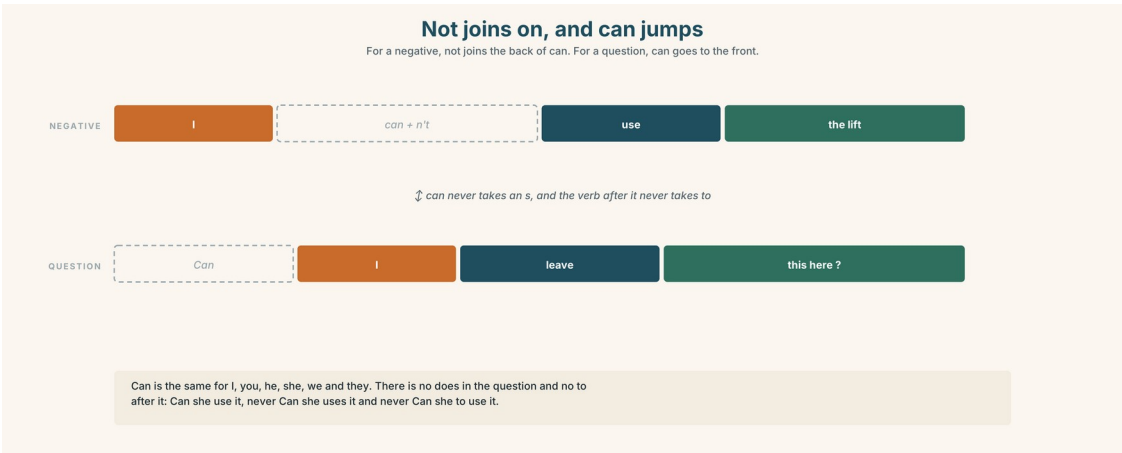
6in}

One word, three destinations — Can does not change. What changes is the situation it lands in.

3C • Know

ability	what a body or a mind does	<i>I can carry it. I can't carry it up four floors.</i>
permission	somebody decided, and they could decide otherwise	<i>You can use the lift. Students can't.</i>
prohibition	a rule, and the person who made it is gone	<i>You can't smoke here.</i>

Can never changes. No **s** for *he* and *she*. No *do* in the question. The verb after it is always plain: *can go*, never *can goes* and never *can to go*.



{width=6.

6in}

Not joins on, and can jumps — For a negative, not joins the back of can. For a question, can goes to the front.

– I **cannot** use it · I **can't** use it · She **can't** come today

? **Can** I leave this here? · **Can** you help me? · **Can** she use the lift?

short answers Yes, you can. · No, I'm sorry, I can't.

The polite layer sits on top. *Can I...?* is a question. *Could you...?* is the same question with the sharp edge taken off. *Is it OK if...?* asks whether the rule allows it rather than whether you allow it.

Why it matters. Half of what you need in a building you do not own is permission, and the other half is finding out who gives it.

3D • Use — controlled

Complete with **can**, **can't**, **Can I** or **Could you**.

Dona Filipa (1) _____ use the lift. Students (2) _____ use it. (3) _____ leave my bag here? — Yes, of course. (4) _____ open the window? It is very warm. I (5) _____ carry this up four floors. I (6) _____ carry it up one.

3E • Use — guided

Make each one a question with *can*, then make it more polite.

1. You want to open the window.
2. You want to leave early.
3. You want to use somebody's charger.
4. You want somebody to say it again.
5. You want to sit at this desk.

3F • Use — open

In pairs. Ask for five things in this room. Your partner says yes, no, or *just a moment*. **Nobody may say no twice in a row.**

3G • Check — six items, mark your own

1. She _____ (not use) the lift.
2. _____ I leave my bag here?
3. He _____ (carry) it, but not up four floors.
4. _____ you open the window, please? (*the polite one*)
5. × *She cans use the lift.* → correct it.
6. × *Can you to help me?* → correct it.

The s with nowhere to go

✗ She cans use it.

cans - an s on a word that has no room

She

The s you learned in Unit 3 is for ordinary verbs. Can is not an ordinary verb; it is a helper, and helpers are the same for everybody. There is no cans, no canned and no to can. The word simply does not move.

✔ She can use it.

can - identical for all six people

She

One form, six people. That makes can easier than every ordinary verb in the language, and it is the reason learners reach for it when they are tired. The verb after it stays plain: use, go, come, never to use.

What the writer thought:
 You have just spent a unit putting an s on he and she. The habit is new and it is strong, and it reaches for the nearest verb. Can is the first word in this book that refuses it, and there are only about ten such words in all of English.

6in}

0-3 → Workbook pp. 16-19. **4-5** → Part 6. **6** → page 90.

4A • Fluency starter — the asking round

4B • The functional core — asking, giving and refusing

The same request, twice

Three words on the left, nine on the right, at the same desk, to the same person.

three words

"Open the window." - no

nine words

"Excuse me - could you open the window, please?" - yes

Find the six. Which one got the yes - and is it the one you expected?

6 differences — find them all

6in}

Language Bank

asking	<i>Can I...? · Could you...? · Is it OK if...?</i>
the small words	<i>please · sorry · excuse me · thank you</i>
saying yes	<i>Of course. · Here you are. · No problem.</i>
saying wait	<i>Just a moment.</i>
saying no	<i>I'm sorry, I can't.</i>
afterwards	<i>Thanks a lot.</i>

Information gap. Learner A has the list of what is allowed. Learner B has the list of what happens anyway. **Find the two rules that nobody follows and nobody minds.**

4C • The performance — three requests

Ask three people in this room for three things. **Three minutes.** One request must be:

something easy · something you expect a no to · something you are genuinely not sure about

Then report: who said yes, who said no, and **who said something that was neither. Record it.**

4D • Observer

One person listens for **one thing**: did anybody say no without the word *sorry*?

4E • Two criteria

☐ Did I use a different form for each of the three requests? ☐ Did I say thank you after the no as well as after the yes?

Part 5 • Reading A • THE WORLD

5A • Predict

The title is "**Who put that there?**" **How many of the signs in your school do you think have a name on them?**

5B • Read — sixty seconds

Who put that there?

Escola Monte has eleven signs. Ana counted them.

Four of them are printed and screwed to the wall. They are about fire and about the law, and the city put them there. Nobody argues with those four.

Four more are printed and taped. They are about the lift, the toilet and the corridor. The school put them there, four years ago, and three of the four people who decided are not here now.

Three are handwritten. One says *Out of order*, and the lift has worked since March. One says *Please be quiet* on a door nobody opens. One says *Keep right*, and the corridor is too narrow for anybody to keep anything.

Eleven signs. Four of them have a reason you can still find. The other seven are rules that are nobody's rules now, and everybody follows them anyway.

5C • Answer

1. How many signs are there?
2. Who put the first four up?
3. What does the handwritten sign on the lift say?
4. How many signs have a reason you can still find?
5. **Why does the writer say "nobody's rules"?**
6. **The last sentence says everybody follows them anyway. Why would people follow a rule that belongs to nobody?**

5D • Vocabulary in context

Guess from the text. Then check.

screwed to the wall · taped · argues with · since March · too narrow

5E • The counter-text

The notice on the lift
One piece of paper. Three hands. No name.

LIFT

STAFF ONLY

Underneath, in blue pen, in a second hand: "and students with a teacher"

Under that, in pencil, in a third hand: "ask Ana"

WHAT IS ALSO ON THE PAPER

A date in the corner	11 / 09
A year	not written
A name	none
Tape	four pieces, one lifted

The printed line is a rule. The blue line is an exception to it.
The pencil line is neither - it is the name of a person, and it is the only part of this notice that tells you what to do next.

Printed, so it looks official.
Nobody knows who printed it

A second hand widened the rule.
Could they?

A third hand gave up and named a person

Eleven September. Four years ago, if you ask Ana

Three people wrote here. One of them had the authority

6in}

The notice on the lift — One piece of paper. Three hands. No name.

Read the notice and answer.

1. What does the printed line say?
2. **What does the handwritten line add, and does it agree with the printed line?**
3. What is the date in the corner?
4. **Three people wrote on this notice. Which one of the three had the authority to?**

5F • Two texts

The text says the lift has worked since March. The notice says *Out of order*.

Which one is the rule? Say one sentence.

Part 6 • Vocabulary Lab 2 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

The small words that do all the work

Open the window, at six temperatures
The same request, six times. Only the beginning and the end change.

1



1 "Open the window."

2



2 "Open the window, please."

3



3 "Can you open the window?"

4



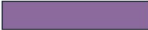
4 "Could you open the window?"

5



5 "Is it OK if I open the window?"

6



6 "Sorry - would you mind if I...?"

{width=6.

6in}

Open the window, at six temperatures — The same request, six times. Only the beginning and the end change.

6A • The ones that catch everybody

excuse me	before you speak to somebody
sorry	after you have done something, or when the answer is no
please	inside the request, not at the beginning of the conversation
thank you	after a yes and after a no

6B • Say them

please • sorry • excuse me • thank you • Of course. • Here you are. • Just a moment.

6C • Chunk

1. **_____ me** — you want somebody's attention
2. **Can _____ ...?** — you want to do something
3. **Could _____ ...?** — you want somebody else to do something
4. **Is it _____ if...?** — you want to know whether the rule allows it
5. **Here _____ are.** — you are handing something over
6. **Thanks a _____ .** — warmer than thank you, and shorter

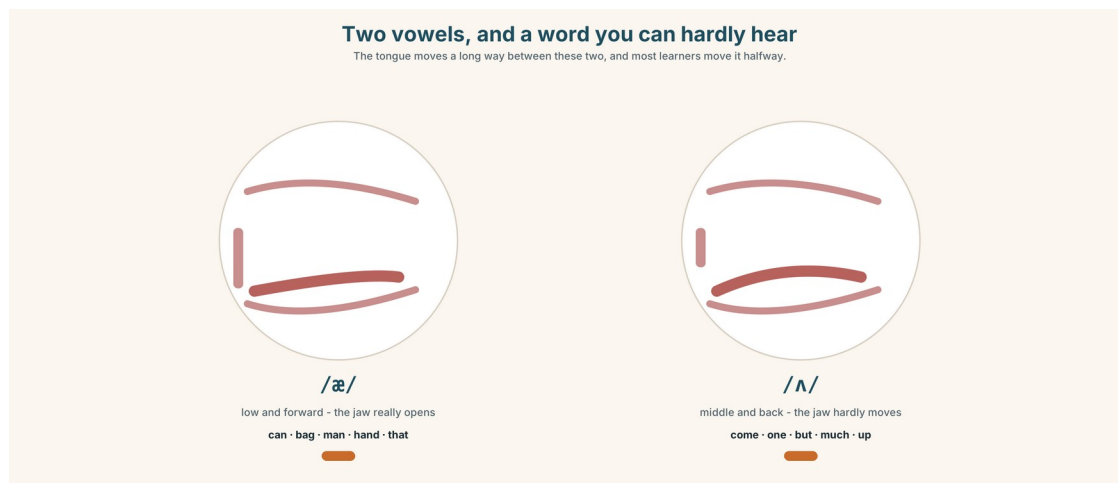
6D • Contrast Clinic

Six items. **excuse me** or **sorry**?

1. You want to ask a stranger a question. _____
 2. You stand on somebody's foot. _____
 3. You want to get past somebody in the corridor. _____
 4. You cannot lend somebody your charger. _____
 5. You arrive ten minutes late. _____
 6. You need to interrupt two people talking. _____
-

Part 7 • Pronunciation & Fluency Lab ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

/æ/ and /ʌ/, and the *can* you can hardly hear



{width=6.

6in}

Two vowels, and a word you can hardly hear — The tongue moves a long way between these two, and most learners move it halfway.

7A • Hear

/æ/ — can · bag · man · hand · that /ʌ/ — come · one · but · much · up

7B • Say

Say each group three times. Then say this:

I can come, but I can't come up. — both vowels, twice each, in one sentence.

7C • Make it mean something

Say these two:

I can go. — *can* is short and quiet. You hardly hear it. *I can't go.* — *can't* is long and loud, and it is the stressed word in the sentence.

The negative is louder than the positive. If you cannot hear the *t*, listen to the length instead. Which one is which?

7D • Fluency 20

Twenty seconds: **three things you can do and three things you can't do in this building.** Three times, faster.

Part 8 • Writing C • THE PERFORMANCE

The rules of a place • 40–60 words

8A • Read the model

You can come in before nine. The door is open from eight. [what you can do, first]

You can't smoke anywhere, including the yard. [the one hard rule, with the gap closed]

Please be quiet in the corridor on the second floor. There is an exam room. [the rule, and then the reason]

If you need the lift, ask at reception. Somebody will say yes. [the rule that is really a door, not a wall]

Questions about the writer's choices:

1. The first sentence is about what you **can** do. **Why not start with the hard rule?**
2. *There is an exam room.* **What does giving the reason do to the rule?**
3. The last rule tells you who to ask. **Why is that more useful than the rule itself?**

8B • The anti-model

No smoking. No food. No phones. Be quiet. Keep right. No bags in the corridor. Students can't use the lift.

Correct English, and nobody will read past the third line. **Rewrite it so that two of the seven are things you can do, and one of them gives a reason.**

8C • Plan

what you can do → the one real prohibition → one rule with a reason → who to ask

8D • Write — 40 to 60 words

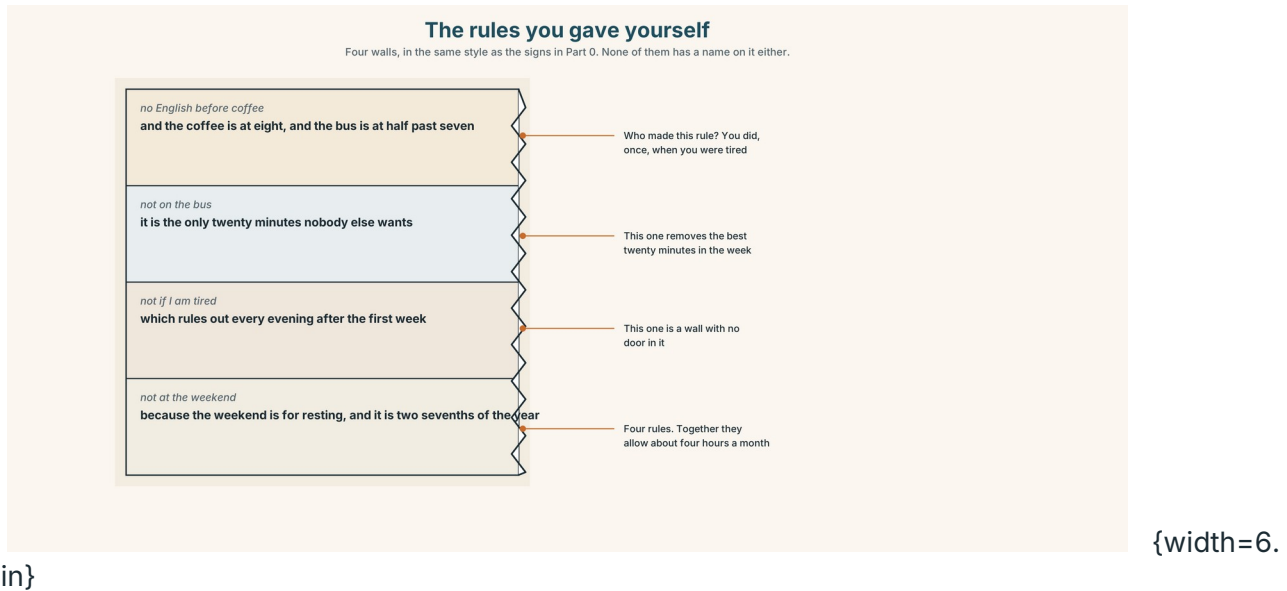
8E • Peer review — two things only

☐ Is there at least one sentence with *can* and not *can't*? ☐ Is there one reason anywhere in it?

8F • Publish

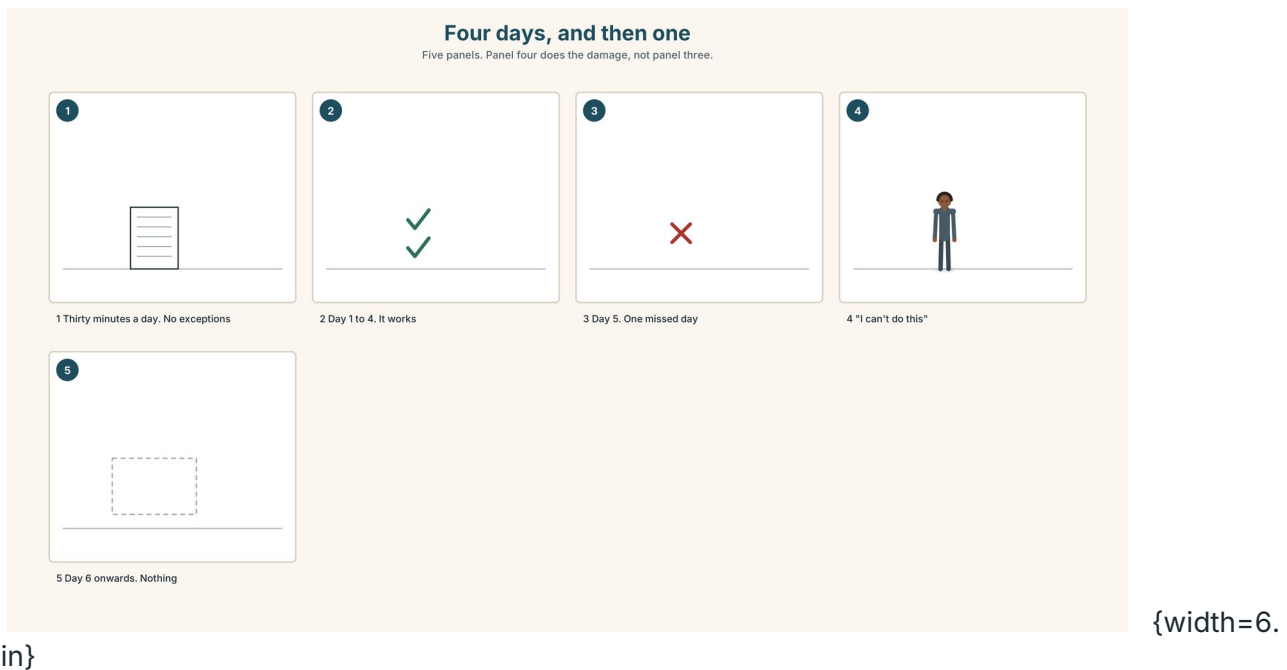
On the door of the classroom. **Keep them up for a week and see which one people actually follow.**

STUDY FILE • The rules you have made for yourself



The rules you gave yourself — Four walls, in the same style as the signs in Part 0. None of them has a name on it either.

9A • Four walls



Four days, and then one — Five panels. Panel four does the damage, not panel three.

What people decide

thirty minutes, every day, no

What happens on day five

exceptions

What people conclude

one missed day

I can't do this.

What is actually true

they did four days, which is four more than before

9B • A rule you can break

A rule you can break and keep is a rule. A rule you cannot break is a wall, and you will walk away from it. **Write one rule for your English this week that has a way out in it.**

Example: twenty minutes a day, and on a bad day, two minutes.

9C • Role play — asking yourself for permission

In pairs. One of you wants to skip today. The other is the part of you that made the rule. Use *Can I...?*, *Is it OK if...?* and *I'm sorry, I can't.* **Swap after two minutes.**

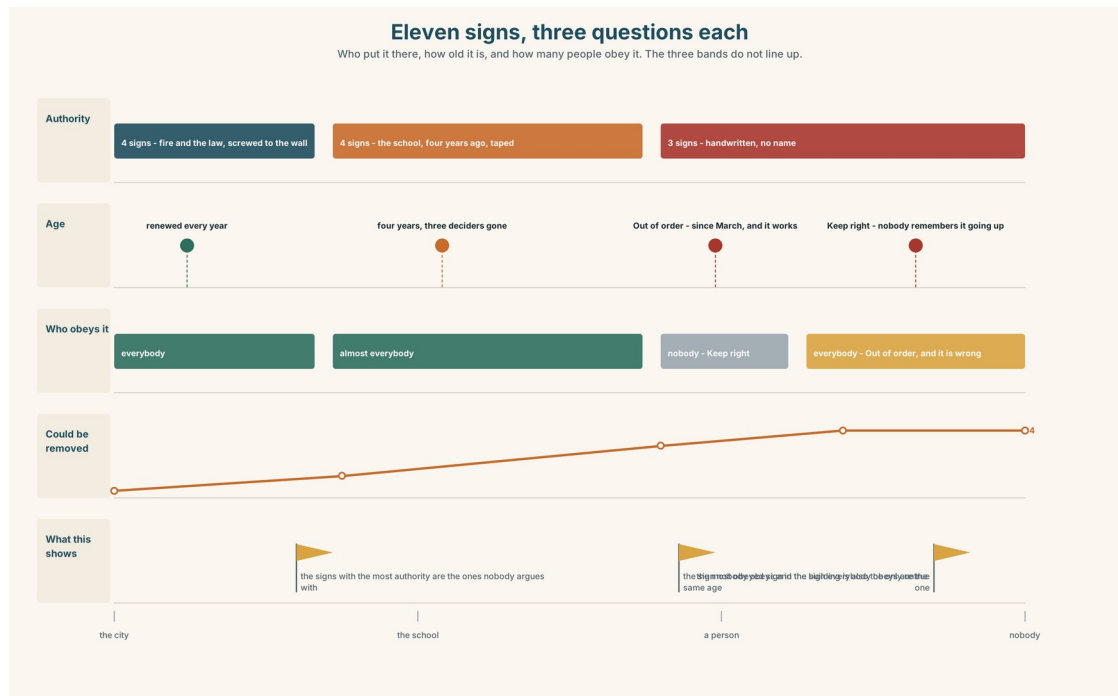
9D • Who made that rule?

Find one rule you follow about your own learning that somebody else made — a teacher, a parent, an app. **Is it still a good rule? Is the person still here?**

9E • Transfer — before next week

Write down every time you nearly studied and did not, for seven days. Write the reason. Do not judge it. Bring the list.

Part 10 • Mediation & Interaction ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE



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Eleven signs, three questions each — Who put it there, how old it is, and how many people obey it. The three bands do not line up.

10A • Relay

Half the class has who wrote each sign. Half has whether people follow it. **Rebuild the whole building by speaking.** Ten minutes.

10B • Simplify — for one person

A new student asks: *Can I use the lift?* **Answer in three sentences.** The true answer is complicated. Say it anyway.

10C • Online

Write **one message** asking a classmate for something you need. **Two sentences.** One of them must give a reason.

10D • Your language

Does your language have a polite form for asking? **Ask for a pen in your language, twice:** once to a friend and once to a stranger. How many words change?

Part 11 • The Decision ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

The lift

Escola Monte has one lift. The notice says *Staff only*. It has said that for four years.

A student broke the door of the lift in the first year, and that is why the notice is there. That student finished the course in the same year and left.

Dona Filipa carries a trolley up four floors twice a day. One student this term cannot use the stairs at all. The school can leave the notice, take it down, or put a key on the lift and give the key to reception.

11A • The evidence

The same lift door, twice
The rule is identical in both. Only the paper is different.

as it is	with a name on it
STAFF ONLY · no name · no date · a queue on the stairs	Ask at reception · A. Silva, March · a key hook

Find the six. One of them is behind the door, on the stairs - and it is the one that measures whether this worked.
6 differences — find them all

{width=6.

6in}

The same lift door, twice — The rule is identical in both. Only the paper is different.

 **Track 4.6.** Dona Filipa, 20 seconds: "I can use the lift. Nobody told me I can. I read the paper on the door every morning for four years and I take the stairs."

11B • Talk about it

In threes. Use the frame. Everybody says one.

I think the lift should be _____, because _____.

Words you can use: *staff · student · key · stairs · trolley · broken · allowed*

11C • Decide

Write **two sentences**. Choose, and say why.

I think the lift should be _____, because _____.

11D • Model decision

Take the old notice down and put up a new one with a name and a date on it. The rule can stay exactly the same. What changes is that there is now somebody to ask, and a rule you can ask about is a different kind of rule.

11E • The Reveal

What happened. Ana printed a new notice: *Lift: ask at reception. A. Silva, March.* The rule did not change. In the first week eleven people asked, and she said yes to all eleven.

Then something she did not expect: the asking stopped after two weeks, and people simply used the lift. Nobody broke it. Ana left the notice up anyway, because the name on it was doing something the rule was not.

One question. You do not have to answer it out loud.

The rule did not change and the behaviour did. So what was the rule actually doing before?

Part 12 • Landing ♦ all three lines

12A • Recycle — twelve items

1. She _____ (not use) the lift.
2. _____ I leave my bag here?
3. _____ you say that again, please? (*the polite one*)
4. Is it _____ if I open the window?
5. _____ me — where is the toilet?
6. I'm _____, I can't.
7. Here you _____.
8. Just a _____.
9. The lift is out of _____.
10. Please _____ your books away.
11. (*Unit 3*) How _____ does he check his phone?
12. (*Unit 2*) They _____ at half past six.

12B • Consolidate — one task, everything in it

Write the rules of a place you know well, in six sentences. Two must use *can*, one must use *can't*, and one must say who to ask.

12C • Can-do, with evidence

☐ I can ask for permission in three different ways. **Evidence:** 4C ☐ I can refuse politely. **Evidence:** 3F, 6D ☐ I can use *can* and *can't* for ability and for rules. **Evidence:** 3G ☐ I can hear the difference between *can* and *can't*. **Evidence:** 7C

12D • Replay 🟡

Record 0C again. **Listen to both.** What is different?

12E • Glossary — thirty-five words, as a map

THE PLACES • entrance • exit • stairs • lift • corridor • toilet **THE RULE WORDS** • rule • sign • open • closed • quiet • allowed • forbidden • smoking **WHAT SIGNS SAY** • No smoking • Please be quiet • Keep right • Out of order • Push / Pull • Mind the step **WHAT YOU DO** • put away • take off **ASKING** • Can I...? • Could you...? • Is it OK if...? **THE SMALL WORDS** • please • sorry • excuse me • thank you **ANSWERING** • Here you are. • Of course. • Just a moment. • No problem. • I'm sorry, I can't. • Thanks a lot.

12F • Next

Unit 5 • How do you learn a word?